

Is Malta first in the EU for reported pollution?

A media claim, tested against Eurostat survey data

THE CLAIM

“35% of people in Malta reported exposure to pollution in 2023 — the highest share in the EU.”

Amphora Media, 2026 Election Guidebook: The Environment, 12 May 2026

Citing Eurostat; the series is not named in the guidebook.

The survey asks about pollution, grime or other environmental problems: what people report.

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

*Accurate figures;
reported, not measured.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

34.7%

The figure is right

Eurostat EU-SILC, 2023: people reporting pollution, grime or other environmental problems.

12.2%

Nearly three times the EU

EU-27 average in 2023. The ratio is 2.8.

1st

Highest in the EU

Greece is second at 20.5%. Malta was first in all 17 survey years since 2005.

41% → 27%

Fell, then rose again

Share reporting problems: 41.4% in 2011, 26.5% in 2017, 34.7% in 2023.

Reported

Perception, not measurement

The intro says “exposure”; the survey records what households report.

FAIR TO SAY

Amphora’s body text uses the survey’s own wording, and its note that higher earners reported more problems matches the data (35.6% against 30.1%).

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The report Amphora cites for the figure.

☐ Measured exposure data to set beside this survey.

☐ Why 2021 and 2022 have no data (survey module).